Day 31 - Mill Pond, Cataract

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Caledon Hills section · hike 40 · Forks of the Credit Provincial Park

9.3 km / 5.8 mi	~2.8 h	2.7 km new	52 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

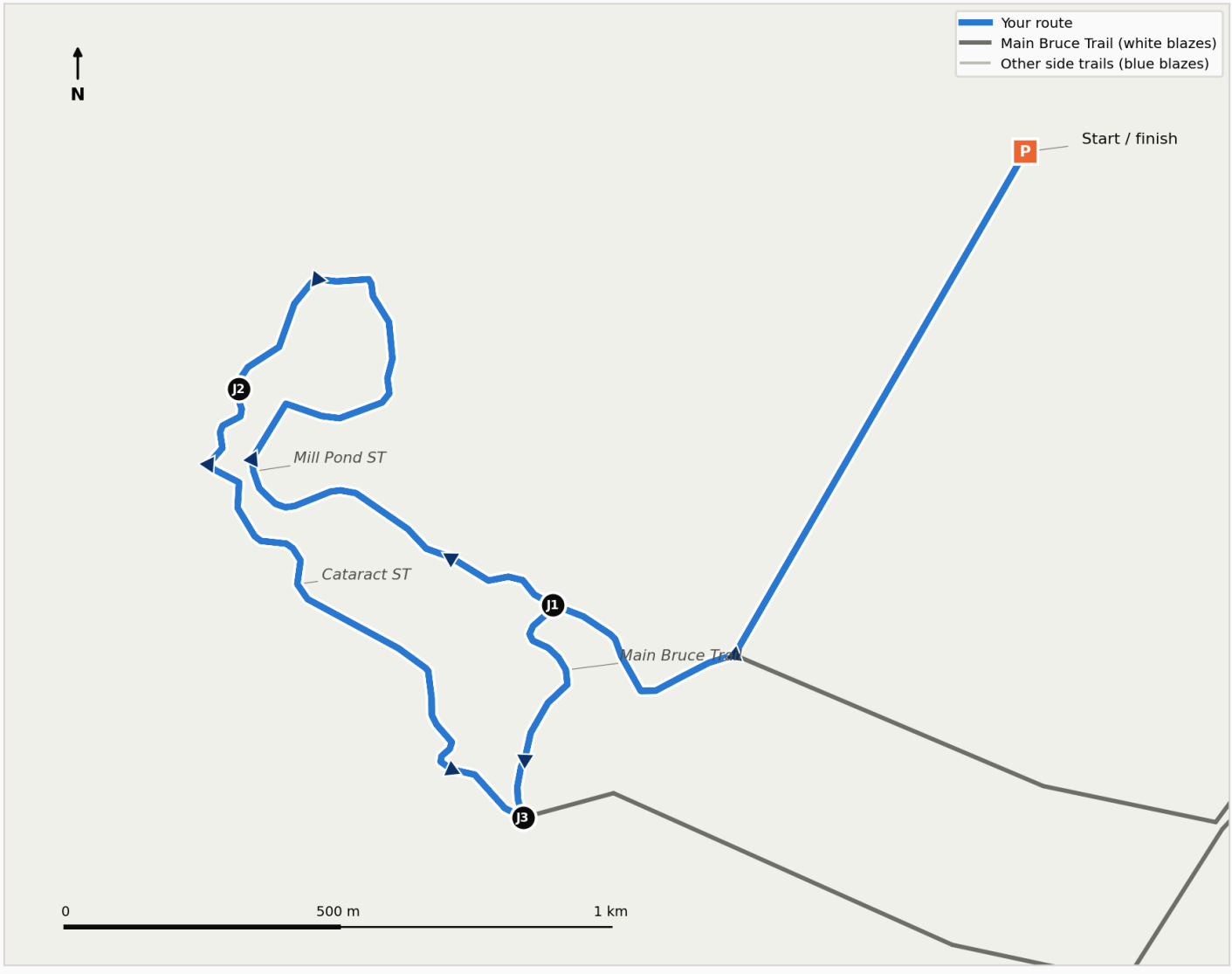
Park (P): Forks of the Credit Parking Area: Enter from McLaren Rd (1.9 km south of Peel Rd 24). From the lot, take either the Meadow Trail or the Trans Canada Trail to the main Trail. Google Maps. **Paid: $18 per vehicle (full day), $8.50 (4 hours) · book ahead** · online at reservations.ontarioparks.com or 1-888-668-7275; Advance daily vehicle permit required; no entry without permit; seasonal permit holders book free

Navigate: import *day31_hike040.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Mill Pond Side Trail (1.6 km); Cataract Side Trail (1.1 km)

Route map

Day 31 | 9.3 km (5.8 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** the Ontario Parks lot off McLaren Rd has limited space, and an advance daily vehicle permit is required (no entry without one). Permits open at 7 am five days ahead, as 4-hour slots or a full day, at reservations.ontarioparks.com or 1-888-668-7275. Roadside parking on nearby roads can be ticketed or towed.
- **Getting to the main Trail:** the park notes the Meadow Trail connection has been closed for infrastructure damage. If it's still signed closed, use the Trans Canada Trail from the lot.

- **Mill Pond Side Trail:** named for the reservoir that powered a grist mill over the falls; John Deagle later used the site to generate electricity. Expect metal stairs on this trail.
- **Cataract Side Trail:** leads to a lookout over Cataract Falls (about 13-14 m high and 9 m wide) and follows the Credit River. The stone foundations of the Cataract Electric Company (1899-1947) sit at the crest of the falls. View the ruins from the trail.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** white blazes through the park on the Niagara Escarpment. Construction at the Forks of the Credit has caused temporary reroutes nearby, so follow current blazes and signs.
- **Dogs:** Ontario Parks rules: leash no longer than 2 m, and pick up after your dog. Ticks are common here; check yourself and the dog afterwards.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Forks of the Credit Parking Area: Enter from McLaren Rd (1.9 km south of Peel Rd 24). Walk about 1.5 km along the road to reach the trail (keep the dog close). Head west on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
1.5	0.9	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Mill Pond Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
3.1	1.9	J2: End of the Mill Pond Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.7	2.9	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
5.1	3.2	J3: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Cataract Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.2	3.9	J2: End of the Cataract Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
7.4	4.6	J3: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
7.8	4.9	J1: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the Mill Pond Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.3	5.8	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Ontario Parks blog, Hiking the GTA, and Caledon Hills Bruce Trail Club pages.